



United States
Attorney's Office
District of Connecticut



Waterford Woman Sentenced to 2 Years in Prison for Stealing from Addiction and Mental Health Services Nonprofit

Wednesday, January 29, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, District of
Connecticut

Marc H. Silverman, Acting United States Attorney for the District of Connecticut, announced that MICHELE DEVINE, 51, of Waterford, was sentenced today by U.S. District Judge Stefan R. Underhill in Bridgeport to 24 months of imprisonment, followed by three years of supervised release, for embezzling from the Southeastern Regional Action Council on Substance Abuse, Inc. ("SERAC"), where she was employed as its executive director. Judge Underhill also ordered Devine to pay a \$2,000 fine and perform 300 hours of community service while on supervised release.

According to court documents and statements made in court, SERAC, headquartered in Norwich, is a 501(c)(3) organization that serves 41 towns in southeastern and northeastern Connecticut with substance abuse, problem gambling, and mental health related services. SERAC is primarily funded through hundreds of thousands of dollars in state and federal grants from the State of Connecticut's Department of Mental Health and Addiction Services, and the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration.

Devine was the executive director of SERAC until July 2022. Beginning in approximately 2008, Devine spent thousands of dollars on purchases that did not relate SERAC but instead were personal expenses for Devine and her family, including thousands of dollars spent on home appliances; travel; timeshare fees at a Connecticut resort; stays at the Canyon Ranch in the Berkshires, Massachusetts; and private school donations.

Judge Underhill ordered Devine to pay \$397,064.93 in restitution.

Devine was arrested on August 3, 2023. On October 21, 2024, she pleaded guilty to wire fraud.

Devine, who is released on a \$25,000 bond, is required to report to prison on March 12.

This matter was investigated by the Federal Bureau of Investigation and the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, Office of Inspector General, with the assistance of the New London State’s Attorney’s Office and the State of Connecticut Office of the Attorney General. The case was prosecuted by Assistant U.S. Attorney Ray Miller.

Updated January 29, 2025

Topics

FINANCIAL FRAUD

HEALTHCARE FRAUD

Component

[USAO - Connecticut](#)

Related Content

PRESS RELEASE

Ecuadoran National Charged with Offenses Related to Theft of U.S. Treasury Funds

EDISON JOVANNY DUTA PINDO, 43, a citizen of Ecuador unlawfully residing in the United States, has been charged in a seven-count indictment with offenses related to the theft of U.S...

August 10, 2026

PRESS RELEASE

Colombian National Sentenced to 57 Months in Federal Prison for Role in Nationwide Jewelry Theft Ring

HAROLD RAMIREZ CAGUA, also known as "Gordo," 42, a citizen of Colombia last residing in Miami, Florida, was sentenced today by U.S. District Judge Kari A. Dooley in Bridgeport to...

July 29, 2026

PRESS RELEASE

Antiques and Art Dealer Pleads Guilty to Federal Charge Stemming from \$2.1 Theft Scheme

DAVID L. JOHNSON, 66, of Greenwich, pleaded guilty yesterday before U.S. District Judge Sarah F. Russell in New Haven to an offense stemming from his embezzlement of more than \$2...

July 22, 2026



District of Connecticut

Main Office:

